TRAVEL POLICY

Effective January 1st, 2019

Reviewed and updated on July 1st, 2026

Enacted

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President & CEO

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1. Objective

The objective of this policy is to manage a travel process fully compliant with the 2 CFR 200, the Federal Acquisition Register (FAR), and Partners' rules and regulations with guidance from U.S. Government procedures.

2. Financial Goal

The financial goal of this policy is to increase accountability and efficiency of travel expenditures and to ensure compliance throughout the full process of USG regulations, 2 CFR 200, the FAR, and other applicable laws, including timely clearance of all travel reports (expense reports, and per diem payments).

3. Traveler Definitions

Partners' travel policy is broken out based on three traveler types. All travelers are expected to comply with and follow the provisions in their respective categories as follows:

- US based/HO
  - US based/Home Office (HO) are all individuals with their principal desk location in the US.
  - This includes but is not limited to:
    - HO staff in the US
    - Consultants
    - Interns
    - Full or partial telecommuting employees, etc.
- Local Field Office and HO staff
  - Local field staff are those on payroll at Partners field offices, including the Country Director
  - Local HO staff are those based in the local field offices but working for HO
  - Local consultant based abroad are consultants paid directly by the field office
  - All other local travelers
- US based/Other
  - Including but not limited to volunteers, board members, etc.

4. Applicability of Policy

This policy applies to US based/HO and Other staff unless otherwise indicated below. Specific guidance at a country and project level may be prepared on a case-by-case basis and approved by the President & CEO. In no event, shall these country or project-specific policies be out of compliance with the procedures and cost/time values identified in the main policy.

5. Requesting Authorization

Staff and consultants considering a trip must discuss with their supervisor the need for the trip, activities to be conducted, funding for related costs, expectations, etc. (Partners' President will notify the Board about their travel plans).

For all travelers including staff, consultants, volunteers, and others traveling under Partners funding, a travel authorization must be prepared prior to incurring any travel costs, including making flight, train, hotel, or other reservation.

5.1 Use of Travel Authorizations

TA's are required for any travel outside of HO (Washington DC/DMV area/or other home office location in the US) or the respective Country Field Office (including city location of country field office) with travel duration of five (5) hours or longer, regardless of the destination or transportation mode. All records and TAs will be stored electronically on SharePoint.

5.1.1 HO Staff, Consultants, Volunteers, etc. (Based in the US)

All travelers must submit a Travel Authorization (TA) in PandaDoc and obtain authorization from their supervisor and the funding approver for all Partners travel. The funding approver on the TA is the individual who is authorized to approve funds from their respective grant and/or unit budget. This may be the same as the traveler's direct supervisor in some cases.

Proper TA's must include the following:

- Traveler's Full Name on Passport
- Address
- Gender
- Date of Birth
- Program/Administration Unit Traveling Under
- Purpose of the Trip/ Scope of Work to be Performed
- Dates of Travel
- Proposed Itinerary
- Approval Authorization from Supervisor and the Funding Approver

For HO staff, the supervisor granting approval for the trip must ensure that proper procedures related to travel notification/approvals from funding agencies are followed. For all funding approvers, the individual is responsible for ensuring adequate funds for the trip in their grant and/or unit budget. All travel plans for HO staff should be entered into the Staff Calendar on Outlook.

5.1.2 Field Staff & Local Consultants (Based outside of the US)

All field staff and local consultants are required to complete a travel authorization and receive approval from their respective supervisors. Effective January 1st, 2022, all staff will complete travel authorizations using the standard template for Replicon. Prior to travel all staff will complete the "Travel Authorization Form" found on SharePoint. This form will collect the following information:

- Traveler's Full Name on official government ID (e.g., Cedula, Passport)
- Date Requested
- Purpose of the Trip/ Scope of Work to be Performed
- Dates of Travel
- Proposed Itinerary

Once the form is completed, it will be uploaded into the Replicon platform at: https://login.replicon.com/. Employees will create a new expense report in Replicon to request approval for the travel authorization. The form will be uploaded into the Replicon database as supporting documentation for the travel. The employee will electronically submit the request for approval. The respective supervisor will then review the proposed travel itinerary, and either approve or reject for modification electronically. Once a fully approved travel itinerary is in Replicon, the employee can proceed with remaining travel plans and bookings.

5.2 Changes to Itineraries

The appropriate supervisor should approve the traveler's itinerary changes. After receiving approval from the supervisor, travelers can contact the appropriate agency to make the necessary changes. Most importantly, it is critical that the supervisor notifies the respective Finance Office (whether in field office or at HO), to ensure that the per diem amount or other changes can be made as necessary. In emergency circumstances, when a supervisor is not available or after hour changes must be made immediately, it is left to the discretion of the travelers. However, they are required to notify their supervisor once the change(s) have been made. Note that the supervisor reserves the right to not approve the change. In such instance, the traveler will be responsible for any difference in cost associated with the change. Disagreements will be resolved by the President & CEO.

When appropriate and once travel authorization has been approved and a draft itinerary established, HO staff will notify the Executive Leadership Team (ELT) of pending travel plans via email **2 weeks prior to travel** (or as soon as possible for urgent travel) to enable staff to provide input on the traveler's itinerary in furtherance of Partners' business development objectives. For example, staff visiting a US Mission in country X to promote a program might be encouraged to pay courtesy calls on key USG personnel to promote additional Partners programs.

6. Insurance Coverage and Security Protocols

For all Partners travelers, if a TA is completed, the below coverage for insurance and security applies as indicated below.

6.1 Travel Insurance

Partners has procured a blanket business travel insurance through AIG. This means Partners travelers are **automatically enrolled in coverage if they are traveling outside of their home country.** Policy information is outlined below and available on SharePoint.

Who does it cover?

The policy covers all Partners travelers both at HO and in the field offices, including staff, consultants, volunteers, and board members. Note: medical, political, and security evacuation is covered for all expatriates and their families, regardless of travel.

What does it cover?

- Travel assistance services including hotel and rental vehicle re-booking, roadside assistance, emergency return travel arrangements, assistance with lost/stolen baggage, assistance with lost passport or travel documents, emergency telephone interpretation assistance and many other services
- Medical emergency evacuation
- Out-of-Country medical expense (does cover medical expenses related to COVID-19)
- Physician/hospital/dental/vision referrals while out of home country
- Emergency prescription replacement (if medications are lost or stolen)
- Dispatch of doctor or specialist to bedside in country
- In-patient and out-patient medical case management
- Security and political evacuations
- Natural disaster coverage
- Support for identity theft
- Accidental death, dismemberment and paralysis including home and vehicle alterations if needed
- Physical therapy, psychological or rehabilitation
- Bereavement and trauma counseling
- Carjacking
- **And many more services**, please reference full policy for more information

When does it cover costs?

The policy provides the attached benefits when a Partners traveler leaves their home country and travels to another country. This means it would cover a Colombian staff member traveling to Panama, as they are leaving their home country, however, it will not cover a Colombian staff member while traveling in Colombia. All medical claims for travelers within their home country will default to their primary insurance and not covered under this policy.

How to access information and ID cards?

To review coverage, ID cards, access security and travel alerts & information, and more, Partners travelers need to **create an account** and enter policy number: **9158541**. All Partners travelers should create a separate account as ID cards are issued based on the registration information.

Security Alerts Enrollment

The traveler can also elect to received security and travel alerts for the expected travel plans down to the country and city level when logged into their **AIG account.**

Contact Information for AIG Insurance

Policyholder: Partners of the Americas, Inc.
Policy Number: 9158541
Toll-Free/Free Phone (within the U.S.): **1-877-244-6871**
Collect/Reverse Charge (outside the U.S.): **+1-715-346-0859**
Email: **assistance@aig.com**
aig.com/us/travelguardassistance

6.2 Security Provider

All travelers both domestic and internationally are covered by Partners security provider RSM. In event of an immediate life-threatening situation while travelling internationally for work Partners has contracted RSM to provide the following services:

- Emergency and crisis response
- Assist with security, political, medical, natural disaster, and other evacuations
- Safe evacuation routes
- Safe houses
- Other security services as needed by the situation.

To report an emergency or security event call the hotline: +1 209-330-8454, which is available in multiple languages 24/7. More information on the services for RSM is available on SharePoint.

6.3 Security Protocols

Partners takes precautions to protect the health and well-being of its travelers while carrying out their duties and responsibilities on behalf of Partners. Partners adheres to Partners' Global Safety and Security Policies. Partners policies consists of a risk assessments, and standard security protocols for each country designed to mitigate threats and maintain contingency planning.

Prior to taking a trip, the traveler should review the respective countries' Pre-Travel Arrival Briefing. All travelers are expected to report all security and safety incidents. Please speak with your supervisor, your Department head or the President & CEO should you have any questions regarding Partners' security and safety protocols.

7. Travel Advances

Travel advances for staff are generally not given, unless there is an exceptional circumstance authorized by Partners HO. Instead, the Partners will pay in advance for lodging, transportation, airfare, and other travel costs to the extent possible.

In certain circumstances with authorized, only staff can request a travel advances for additional, necessary cash. Any staff travel advance must be requested before a trip and in accordance with Partners payment processing cycle. The request must include justification and the amount requested. The request must be accompanied by an approved TA. Advance will be limited to 75% of the total M&IE estimated amount. All advances should be cleared 30 days from the issue date, unless the travel period extends beyond two weeks in which case, the staff member has 60 days to clear the advance.

8. Allowable and Unallowable Expenses

The following allowable and unallowable expenses apply to all Partners travelers regardless of their relationship, funding source, or the location of their office.

8.1 Allowable expenses and reimbursement limitations

Partners has a travel policy that provides a per diem for all Meals & Incidental Expenses (M&IE), while all other miscellaneous travel expenses, lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare, and train costs are reimbursed based upon actual expenses incurred. Allowable expenses are also limited to the conditions established on grants and agreements with funding agencies sponsoring the trip. Detailed receipts are required for all reimbursable cost $25.00 USD or more.

Furthermore, only allowable expenses are reimbursable under the category other miscellaneous travel expenses, lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare, and trains. No later than 30 days following the final day of a trip, an Expense Reimbursement Report should be prepared and submitted to the traveler's respective Finance Office (whether in field or at HO). Partners will not accept reimbursement requests made after 60 days unless approved by Senior Management at HO. All travelers requesting an exception must make their requests in writing with a valid reason for the delay.

8.1.1 Lodging – Reimbursable Based

Lodging is defined as room charges and taxes. For reimbursement purposes, a detailed receipt must be provided which indicates the traveler's name, dates of travel, and room rates and taxes. These receipts cannot include room service fees, upgrade fees, mini bar tabs, entertainment fees, etc. All of these other expenditures must be paid by the traveler using their personal or per diem funds and excluded from their lodging bill.

Partners will recognize and reimburse lodging costs based on actual expenses, but the USG ceiling rates shall be a guide to appropriate expenditures per country and must not be exceeded. Lodging rates for the U.S. and U.S. territories do not include taxes, however for all foreign lodging, the rate already includes taxes.

Exceptions above the maximum rate must be requested and approved in writing prior to incurring the cost. Exceptions are only approved by the President & CEO with a CC to compliance@partners.net. A list of USG guidance is provided below:

- General Services Administration (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The Department of Defense (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The State Department establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

8.1.2 Rental Cars – Reimbursable Based

The cost of rental cars including rental car insurance is allowed only if the nature of the trip or the location of business to be visited is such, that use of field transport or local transportation is unavailable, impractical, or unsafe, as determined by the traveler's supervisor. If deemed necessary and approved as part of the TA process, Partners will recognize and reimburse rental car costs based on actual expenses. Prior to reimbursement, the respective Finance Office (whether in the field or at HO), will need to check that the TA includes an explanation (specific uses) as to why a car rental was necessary.

Note, Partners does not carry a blanket collision damage waiver policy nor is the traveler covered with liability insurance if collision with the rental vehicle were to occur. Partners recommends the purchase of collision and liability insurance each time a car is rented.

8.1.3 Use of Personal Vehicle – Reimbursable Based

The use of a personal vehicle while on travel within the US is permitted in lieu of airline transportation if approved by the supervisor. The traveler will be reimbursed for gas mileage in accordance with the IRS standard mileage rate.

8.1.4 Tolls, Parking, Etc. – Reimbursable Based

For business travel, if renting a car, using a personal vehicle, or using a Partners' program vehicle, Partners will reimburse based on actual costs for all tolls, parking and other costs associated to the use of the vehicle. These types of expenditures are reimbursed based on actual charges incurred and a receipt must be provided for expenses over $25.

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8.1.5 Airfare and Trains – Reimbursable Based

Partners will reimburse or purchase on behalf of all approved travelers all necessary airfare and train tickets. For reimbursement purposes, a receipt must be provided for all airfare and train tickets. Note below the additional restrictions related to airfare purchases. Refundable tickets should only be purchased if the price difference between refundable and nonrefundable is 10% or less than the total ticket, otherwise nonrefundable should always be purchased.

There may be other circumstances in which refundable tickets are necessary and exceed 10% of the ticket value, such cases include but are not limited to project closeout, pending visas, illness, or other situations that may require a flight change. For these exceptional situations, prior approval in writing must be obtained from the President & CEO or Director of Grants and Contracts.

8.1.5.1 Seat Selection

Partners permits staff to select seats, including seats with extra leg room, or in an exit row, assuming the seat is still in the economy cabin.

8.1.5.2 Seat/Class Upgrades

Only coach class or promotional fares will be paid by Partners. Business and first class are considered seat upgrades and must follow the below protocol; otherwise, this will not be covered by Partners. While seat upgrades are not to be expected, there are some circumstances when the traveler could be authorized to travel Business class:

- When no space is available in coach-class accommodation and the particular flight must be taken
- When use of business class is necessary to accommodate traveler disability or a special need
- When the cost is the same or the traveler pays for the difference in cost between coach and the upgrade

With the exception of no-cost upgrades, or the traveler pays for the difference in cost without Partners' funding, all seat upgrades will need to be approved in advance with the President & CEO at HO (for HO staff, consultant and volunteers based in the US) and with the Country Director (for all field staff and local consultants) and must include a written justification as to why the upgrade is necessary.

8.1.5.3 Fly America Act

All US government-funded travel will comply with the Fly America Act, which requires that all travel and shipments must be made on U.S. flag carriers to the extent services by such carriers is available. Use of a Fly America compliant carrier is required regardless of whether a foreign carrier can provide the service at a comparable or lower cost, or whether a foreign carrier is preferred due to convenience. The rules generally provide for a limited number of exceptions; however, a U.S.

carrier must be used for any travel: 1) within the U.S., or 2) between the U.S. and the last destination point that is served by a U.S. carrier for that particular routing. Exceptions to the Fly America Act must be submitted in PandaDoc and approved prior to the trip. The Compliance Team at compliance@partners.net is authorized to approve any exception, which are listed below:

1. When a U.S. air carrier is not available.
2. If a U.S. flag air carrier offers nonstop or direct service (no aircraft change) from your origin to your destination, you must use the U.S. flag air carrier service unless such use would extend your travel time, including delay at origin, by 24 hours or more.
3. If a U.S. flag air carrier does not offer nonstop or direct service (no aircraft change) between your origin and your destination, you must use a U.S. flag air carrier on every portion of the route where it provides service unless, when compared to using a foreign air carrier, such use would:
    - Increase the number of aircraft changes you must make outside of the U.S. by 2 or more; or
    - Extend your travel time by at least 6 hours or more; or
    - Require a connecting time of 4 hours or more at an overseas interchange point; or
    - Double the en-route travel time when service on a foreign air carrier is 3 hours or less.
4. When there is an applicable Open Skies Agreement in effect that meets the requirements of the Fly America Act.

In order for a flight to be in compliance with the Fly America Act, the code of a U.S. flag air carrier must be noted as part of the flight number on the airline ticket, flight coupon (boarding pass), or passenger receipt. Each airline has a two-letter alpha code. From this list, you will be able to compare airline codes on the ticket with those on the list and thereby be able to ascertain whether or not the flight is on a US Flag air carrier. In order to ensure that the flight is Fly America Act compliant all travel should be booked through the designated travel agent/agency.

Many of the U.S. flag air carriers are listed below:

- AirTran Airways (FL)
- Alaska Airlines (AS)
- American Airlines (AA)
- Continental Airlines (CO)
- Delta Airlines (DL)
- Frontier Airlines (F9)
- Hawaiian Airlines (HA)
- JetBlue Airways (B6)
- Midwest Express (YX)
- Southwest Airlines (WN)
- Spirit Airlines (NK)
- United Airlines (UA)
- US Airways (US)

8.1.6 Meals & Incidentals (M&IE) – Per Diem Based

Partners includes the cost of all meals and incidentals under a flat rate per diem provided to the traveler and will NOT reimburse based on actual expenditures. Partial per diem will be provided when one or more of the meals is provided by someone other than the traveler.

For the appropriate amount of the per diem, please reference Section 9, Per Diem for M&IE to determine correct per diem based on the traveler type.

8.1.7 All Other Miscellaneous Travel Expenses (MTE) – Reimbursable Based

All other miscellaneous travel expenses (MTE) are additional expenses and paid as necessary and charged to the Partners credit card or reimbursed based on the actual costs incurred. All MTE expenses over $25 must be supported by receipts/stubs/invoices as part of the expense report in order to be reimbursed. MTE includes but is not limited to the following:

- All ground transportation fees (buses, taxis, etc.) between place of lodging or business and places off site to obtain meals, meetings, site visits, etc. Reasonable amount for tips on shuttles, taxis, or other similar transport is acceptable and reimbursable in addition to the fare cost. Maximum reimbursable tip percentage is 20%.
- Visas
- Passport or renewal if needed
- Cost for Global Entry including TSA Precheck
- Room cleaning cost: Where an apartment is taken in lieu of hotel accommodations, the traveler may contract, however this must come from the incidental travel expense part of the per diem
- Immunizations and medications on travel
- Reproduction of materials
- Telephone calls and other communication costs that are reasonable and necessary for work-related communications, including SIM cards, data, and in-flight Wi-Fi charges.
- Bank fees for ATM withdrawals or fees for currency exchange.
- Reasonable cost for purchase of business attire in the event that baggage is lost/delayed is permitted.

8.1.8 Business Meals Meeting Expense (Non-Travel) – Reimbursable Based

In certain circumstances business meals may be approved as a meeting expense. When dealing with food costs, always keep in mind that “entertainment” costs may not be charged to federal grant awards. The costs must clearly and directly benefit the grant project to which they are being charged. Under Partners policy on occasion a coffee, lunch or even breakfast may be considered a business meal assuming the work agenda is clear and it is not for entertainment purposes. Typically, the cost for dinner will always be unallowable. Expenses for business meals require names of people attending the meeting and the business purpose of the meal, regardless of the amount.

8.1.9 Meals/Refreshments for Conferences Trainings, and Meetings – Reimbursable Based

The cost of meals and refreshments during a conference, training, or meeting is allowable only under the following circumstances:

- The conference/training/meeting is undertaken to further the goals of the project.
- The associated food/refreshment costs appear in the approved project budget.
- There is a formal agenda for the conference/training/meeting and an attendee roster.
- Meals/refreshments provided are necessary to accomplish legitimate meeting or conference business (e.g., a working lunch is provided so that those attending can conduct a planning session or hear a project-related presentation.). The rule of thumb is that conference of 4 hours or longer may include a lunch if attendees cannot leave to obtain their own. Refreshments may typically only be included after 2-3 hours of a conference.

For example, that the cost of a coffee break and a working lunch associated with holding a semi-annual project meeting with attendees from all over the country would typically be allowable. However, in contrast, a welcome lunch or general regular team meetings would not be an allowable cost.

8.2 Unallowable expenses and reimbursement limitations

Partners will not reimburse or cover charges for the below prohibited items. Please note these lists are not inclusive and Partners reserves the right to refuse payment of any authorized or expense deemed unallowable.

8.2.1 Alcohol Purchases

With prior approval (before incurring the expense) from a member of the ELT, Director-level HO staff and above may purchase alcohol for an event or meal when there is clear justification for the alcohol purchases. Approved alcohol purchases can only be charged under department 19300, account code 90400– Unallowable Program Costs. All alcohol purchases are excluded from any Partners NICRA calculation. Please note you will need to split the alcohol from the total bill, including the tax and the tip related to the alcohol.

8.2.2 Personal Purchases on Corporate Credit Cards

No personal purchases are permitted on corporate credit cards. In the event that a personal charge is made on the corporate card, the employee is required to reimburse Partners immediately. On the credit card expense report, the personal expense should be coded to 1201, and the expense should be reimbursed with either cash, check, or credit/debit card. If desired to pay via credit/debit card, please advise the HO Finance Office and they will generate an electronic invoice.

8.2.3 Other Unallowable Expenses

Partners' unallowable expenses include but are not limited to:

- Additional travel insurance, travel accident insurance or trip cancelation premiums
- Non-essential upgrades or packages
- Additional expenses associated with the cost of first or business class airfare, unless it falls into the exception categories listed above
- Childcare and babysitting expenses
- Costs incurred by your failure to cancel transportation or hotel reservations
- Costs incurred by your spouse or other dependents traveling with you, unless spouse or dependents is also on a Partners assignment
- Gasoline expenses when the automobile mileage reimbursement rate is claimed
- Hair styling and haircut expenses
- Spa, nails, or other treatments
- Entertainment or tour expenses, unless activity is required by Partners trip
- Kennel/boarding expenses for pets
- Costs incurred for speeding, parking, towing, impound fees and other traffic/law violations, when renting or driving any vehicle while on Partners business
- Other expenses not directly related to the business purpose of the travel assignment

For a complete list of unallowable expenses for USG funds, please reference 2 CFR Part 200: Unallowable Costs, which includes any potential exceptions to the above unallowable expenses.

9. Per Diem for M&IE

Partners has a travel policy that provides a per diem for all expenses related to meals and incidental expenses (M&IE).

9.1 Per Diem General Guidelines

9.1.1 M&IE rates

All Partners' M&IE per diem rates are based on a percentage of the government per diems allowed per city and/or country, as defined herein and below in Sections 9.1 and Section 9.2. The per diem is always based on the city where the traveler will rest. For example, if the traveler leaves Bogota, Colombia, and travels to San Diego on day one, and returns back home from San Diego on day three, the first two days the per diem should be calculated based on the San Diego rate and the last day on Bogota, Colombia.

Depending on the destination, travelers should utilize the General Service Administration rates for travel within the continental US, the Department of Defense rates for travel to Alaska, Hawaii, and other US territories, and the State Department for all foreign travel. The websites to obtain the rates are listed below:

- General Services Administration (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The Department of Defense (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The State Department establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

Per diems are driven based on the approved TA and include any travel outside of HO or the respective Country Field Office with travel duration of five (5) hours or longer, regardless of the destination or transportation mode. Exceptions to this must be approved by the President & CEO.

9.1.2 M&IE first and last day

On the first and last day of travel, partial per diem must be selected, unless a time exception applies. On the first day of travel, if a partial per diem is used, the traveler should not exclude breakfast from the per diem; Likewise, on the last day of travel, if a partial per diem is used, the traveler should not exclude dinner from the per diem.

On return day, if the traveler lands after 12AM but arrives back home before 6AM, no per diem is provided on that day.

For first and last days of travel (travel days), if the itinerary requires the traveler to start their travel day from their home-of-record (or work-related destination) before breakfast and return to their work-related destination (or home-of-record) after dinner, then the full per diem can be recorded and documented in the expense report. Specifically, the following time exceptions apply and allow the traveler to claim full per diem:

- If departure from home on first day of travel is before 6AM;
- If arrival to home on last day of travel is after 7PM; or
- If travel is for only **one day**, and total travel time that day is 10 hours or longer, regardless of start and end times for the daytrip.

Otherwise, travel day rates will be determined as defined in Sections 9.2, 9.3 or 9.4.

If selecting full per diem on the first or last day of a multiple day trip, you must include a comment indicating the departure time for the first day or your return time on the last day.

9.1.3 M&IE meal breakdown and exclusions

M&IE is intended to cover the reasonable costs of meals and incidentals during each day of work-related travel. If a per diem recipient has one or more meals paid for, the percentage of that meal must be deducted from the per diem rate. If the traveler is unable to eat a provided meal due to allergies, dietary or religious reason, then they are not required to exclude the meal.

Some common examples of Partners provided meals are:

- Continental breakfast or other breakfast included in lodging*
- Work lunch/event paid for by Partners
- Conference registration that includes lunch
- Any other situation in which Partners covers the meal

*If due to Partners approved itinerary the traveler is unable to have breakfast at the hotel, they do not have to exclude. I.e. Breakfast starts at 7AM, but traveler must leave by 6AM. Waking up late or personal preference against the breakfast options, are not sufficient reason to not exclude.

If the daily M&IE rate excludes one or more of the meals, these are to be reduced at the following rates:

- Breakfast: 16% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- Lunch: 24% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- Dinner: 40% of daily calculated M&IE rate

Note that incidentals are calculated at 20% of the total daily rate and excluded from these meal rates; i.e., the sum of incidentals and the three meals is equal to 100% of the daily M&IE.

See examples in Annex A.

9.1.4 M&IE allowable costs

The M&IE portion is intended to cover the costs as described below.

- The meals allowance portion is intended to include the reasonable cost of breakfast, lunch, and dinner while on travel, and is incorporated as part of the per diem.
- Incidental travel expense portion is intended to include but are not limited to:
  - Fees and tips to waiters, porters, baggage handlers, bellhops, hotel servants, dining room stewards, and similar employees
  - Laundry, dry cleaning, and pressing of clothing
  - Room cleaning tips
  - All other incidental travel expenses as defined by Chapter 300, Part 300-3, in the Federal Travel Regulation (www.gsa.gov/ftr), under Per Diem Allowance.

US Based/HO and local field office staff are not permitted to charge a corporate card for meals covered by their per diem, for themselves or any other individual receiving a Partners' per diem. As all Partners travelers receive some form of per diem, their costs should be paid for separately with per diem or personal funds. However, if the meal for the group is charged on a corporate card, this meal must be deducted from the daily per diem rate, at the rate defined above (in Section 9.1.3 M&IE meal breakdown) for the specified meal.

9.1.5 Meals with External Invitees (Donors, Partners, and Other Official Guests)

If US Based/HO or local field office staff need to cover the cost of a meal for external invitees (e.g. donors, partners, government officials, etc.), they may pay the full bill on a corporate card. In that case, they must deduct the cost of their own meal and the meals of any other Partners per diem recipients from the total bill, and pay that deducted amount separately (e.g., on a personal card), if possible. Alternatively, the staff member may instead deduct the cost of their own meal from their daily per diem, using the applicable meal rate defined in Section 9.1.3.

See Section 9.1.6 for the approval process required to cover an invitee's meal, or when a meal exceeds the applicable per diem rate.

If the staff member instead pays with a personal card or cash and intends to seek reimbursement, they will only be reimbursed for the portion of the bill that does not cover meals for Partners' per diem recipients. If the bill cannot be split and the only option is to pay the full amount on a corporate card, the staff member must identify the personal portion (their own meal and the meals of any other per diem recipients) when coding the credit card statement, separating personal charges from business expenses. The staff member is responsible for reimbursing Partners for that personal portion: if they received a per diem advance, they must repay Partners directly; if not, the amount will instead be deducted from their expense report when they request per diem after the trip.

9.1.6 Exception: Donor or Official Guest Meals Exceeding the Per Diem Rate

Partners recognizes that certain business relationship obligations particularly meetings with donors, government officials, and key institutional partners may require meals at venues where menu prices exceed the applicable per diem meal rate. In these instances, the following process applies:

1. **Approval Required.** The staff member must obtain written approval (email is acceptable) from their direct supervisor's supervisor prior to the meal that requires an exception, or, if prior approval is not feasible, no later than 48 hours after the meal. If the cost is to be charged to Admin funding, the exception is also subject to approval by the Sr. VP of Programs or the President & CEO. The approval request must include: the name and organizational affiliation of each invitee, the business purpose of the meeting, the estimated cost per person (or actual cost, if requesting after the meal), and the venue name.

2. **Reasonable and Necessary Standard.** The meal must be reasonable in cost given the location and the nature of the meeting. Extravagant or lavish meals are not reimbursable

under 2 CFR §200.438 (Entertainment Costs). Staff should select the most cost-effective venue appropriate to the business context.

3. **Applicable Per Diem Rate.** For an approved exception meal, the staff member may request reimbursement of up to 100% of the applicable USG per diem rate for that meal, rather than 70% of the standard per-meal cap under Section 9.1.3. If approved, reimbursement will be for the actual cost of the meal, up to that cap. In the event the staff covers the guest/invitee portion, that cost must be an eligible program cost to be charged to the program; if it is not an eligible program cost, it must instead be approved by the Sr. VP of Programs or the President & CEO and charged to Admin funding.

   Example: Assume a staff member is approved under this exception to be reimbursed up to 100% of the USG per diem rate for a dinner with a donor while on travel. If the full USG per diem rate for that city is $100, and the dinner-specific cap under Section 9.1.3 is 40% of that rate, the maximum reimbursable amount is $100 x 40% = $40. Partners would reimburse the staff member up to $40, at actual cost. If the actual cost of the meal is only $35, the staff member would be reimbursed $35, not the full $40 cap. Without an approved exception, the staff member's reimbursement is limited to 70% of that cap: $40 x 70% = $28.

4. **Documentation.** The staff member must submit with their expense report: the approval email, an itemized receipt, the names and affiliations of all attendees, and a brief written description of the business purpose of the meeting.

5. **Frequency and Pattern Review.** Meal exception requests that occur frequently for the same staff member will be subject to review by the ELT to ensure compliance with donor regulations and organizational policy.

9.1.7 M&IE weekend travel

Should a traveler remain away from home on business over a weekend, the per diem will be allowed, assuming that the traveler is required to be away from home over the weekend for business purposes.

9.2 Per Diem M&IE

This portion of the per diem policy guidelines applies to all travelers. For all full days on travel, **travelers will receive 70%** of the government per diem rate for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed).

On the first and last day of travel, in alignment with the USG guidelines the M&IE per diem will be based on **52.5%** of the government per diem rate (75% of 70%) for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed). See exceptions to this in Section 9.1 above.

If the travelers are taking personal vacation time either before or after the Partners business travel, they will not receive Partners per diem those days. The travelers will receive the first and last travel day in accordance with the guidelines listed above, as these travelers would have had to travel to or from the departure whether or not they were on personal travel after or prior to the trip.

A different, lower pre-determined rate can be determined on a case-by-case basis and will require a memo with approval by the managing director <u>and</u> President & CEO.

9.3 Payment of Per Diems

Regardless of the traveler, per diems will only be paid upon the Finance Office's receipt of an approved TA. The approved TA and itinerary will be the supporting documentation and authorization for the issuance of the per diem. No receipts will be required for per diem payment, except as defined in this policy.

All per diem payments should be made within 30 days from the end date of travel. Partners will not accept per diem payment requests made after 60 days unless approved by Senior Management at HO. All travelers requesting an exception must make their requests for exceptions in writing (e.g. memorandum addressed to the Finance office) with a valid reason for the delay.

It is the traveler's responsibility to utilize their per diem to cover all of their meals and incidentals. Unless approved by the President & CEO, no additional M&IE will be provided. The traveler does not need to reimburse the organization if they do not spend all of their daily M&IE.

9.3.1 Per Diem Payment for Local Field Office Staff (Non-US Based)

Local field office staff including the Country Director and all other local travelers outside of the US will be issued their per diem in accordance with that country's guidelines as indicated in the country specific supplemental manual.

9.3.2 Per Diem Payment for US Based/HO and US Based/Other

US Based/HO and US Based/Other travelers can receive their per diem payment either prior to their trip, or upon their return. Per diem payments either before or after travel will be paid out by Bill.com in accordance with normal Partners HO payment cycles.

If a per diem is paid prior to departure and for any reason the traveler departs early or ends their assignment early, or some of their meals have been covered by someone other than the traveler, then the traveler is liable to return the per diem amount paid for the days that they are leaving early or for the meals provided. In the event that the traveler is using a prepaid debit card from Partners, the balance will be reduced in accordance with necessary reduction in per diem. If the traveler owes money to Partners for terminating an assignment early for any reason, and they do not have a balance on their prepaid debit card, then that traveler must repay Partners in another method. Partners reserves the right to take all necessary actions to recover per diem funds from early termination of business travel and assignments.

10. Reduced M&IE and Lodging for Extended Travel

Extended travel refers to trips that are expected to last for a continuous period of 18 days or more away from the employee's regular place of business or residence. For trips classified as extended travel, employee's will receive a reduce M&IE and lodging rate, since employee's should have access to more cost-effective dining and lodging options. Note extended travel reductions will only apply to foreign countries and not the US.

10.1.1 Reduced Extended Travel M&IE

Reduced M&IE allowances are designed to reflect the fact that employees may have access to more budget-friendly dining options or a kitchen while on extended travel. For extended travel, Partners will provide **35%** of the US government per diems allowed for the city and country, see rate sources in 9.1.1. M&IE rates.

10.1.2 Reduced Extended Travel Lodging

Employees on extended travel should seek lodging accommodations that are reasonable and provide a balance between cost-effectiveness and comfort. When possible, the lodging should provide access to a kitchen to reduce meal costs and offer breakfast included with the stay.

For extended travel, Partners will recognize and reimburse lodging costs based on actual expenses up to a ceiling rate of **35%** of the USG rate. The USG ceiling rates for non US location can be found at: the State Department.

11. Reimbursement Requests (Non-Per Diem Items)

Allowable expenses that may be submitted for reimbursement as described above (lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare, and trains) are all reasonable costs which are essential and directly related to the objectives of the grant and/or the main purpose of the trip.

11.1 Expense Reports for Reimbursement

Expense report should be prepared and submitted to the Finance Office at HO or the appropriate field office within 30 days following the end of the trip. HO This report should include the following:

- A fully executed Travel Authorization/Travel Itinerary
- An Expense Report which includes all proper documentation, coding, and receipts for all items $30.00 or more. Expenses for business meals require names of people attending the meeting and the business purpose of the meal, regardless of the amount. Country-specific cost rates shall be defined in the country specific supplemental field office manual.
    - Please note that a bank or credit card statement is not sufficient documentation for a receipt. Where sufficient documentation has not been obtained, an affidavit will need to be filled out confirming the expenses were for business purposes and that

the expenses did not include any alcohol. A copy of an appropriate affidavit is found in Annex B.

- Provide evidence of the exchange rate during the period of travel (a hotel or bank receipt showing a conversion of currency may be a convenient way of satisfying this requirement.)
  - The following sites are also recommended to utilize for obtaining the exchange rate:
    - Oanda: https://fxds-hcc.oanda.com/
    - XE: https://www.xe.com/

11.2 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – Local Field Office Staff (Based outside of the US)

No later than 30 days following a trip as necessary (in which purchases are not made on behalf of the traveler in advance), a reimbursement request should be prepared and submitted to the Field Finance Office in country. The method for requesting reimbursement for local field office staff will be done via the Replicon application. For additional details, please reference the country specific supplemental field office manual.

12. Personal Travel during Business Trips

If, for personal reasons, the traveler wishes to go to places other than those on the authorized Partners itinerary, he/she may book and must pay for those reservations and additional costs. To document the price difference, the traveler must build a cost construct. To build the cost construct the traveler must get two quotes from our travel agents, 1) for the Partners approved dates and routes, and 2) for the traveler's preferred dates and/or routes. The traveler must provide a copy of the cost construct to the Compliance Team if they are booking personal travel/personal portion of the trip. If the flight cost is a cheaper ticket price including personal days on the beginning or end of the trip, the traveler does not need to reimburse any money. Travelers are only responsible for paying the difference of the ticket price. For example, travel dates for business ticket cost equals $500, travel dates including a personal portion of the trip equals $600, the staff must reimburse Partners the $100 difference between business ticket cost and personal portion of the trip. If the personal travel is booked on the same ticket as the Partners authorized trip, the traveler will be responsible for covering their personal travel within 10 days of the booking. Appropriate documentation showing the additional costs must be kept on file for audit purposes.

13. Travel/Trip Reports (When required)

Travel/trip reports are due within 30 days following the completion of the travel from the US Based/HO and Local field office staff. The report must detail out any important results, observations, findings, and recommendations/follow-up plans, etc. The report must be submitted to the individual's supervisor for approval. Once approved, this report will be share with all staff via email. The final approved report will be filed with the expense report. The travel report template is attached in Annex C.

14. Partners HO Travel Agency – Altour

Travel arrangements for approved travelers can be made through Partners HO travel agency, Altour both in English and Spanish. Field offices can utilize the HO travel agency, local travel agency and/or be responsible for booking their own flights, unless in coordination with HO travel is booked under Altour. Prior to the booking of any ticket, a TA with proper authorization from supervisors must be submitted. This includes any travel outside of HO or the respective Country Field Office, regardless of the destination and transportation mode. Prior to flight, hotel, and other bookings through Altour, the agency will require an approved TA for all travelers before the request is processed. The main contact for Altour is located below to assist with travel planning:

English:

- **Penny Smith**
  - Available 9AM-6PM EST Monday – Friday
  - Phone: Please call 717-299-6600
    - Toll Free: 800-343-9594
  - Email: yorkcorpteam@altour.com with "***ATTN: Penny***" in the title
  - Online (Concur)
    - https://www.concursolutions.com
    - User: Partners email
    - Password: Click to reset
- **For emergency after hours support**
  - **Call +1 866-343-9594**

Spanish:

- Available 9AM-7PM EST Monday – Friday
  - Email: viajescorporativos@altour.mx
  - Tel.:+52 558 525 2508
  - Online (Concur)
    - https://www.concursolutions.com
    - User: Partners email
    - Password: Click to reset
- **For emergency after hours support**
  - **Call +55 5980 5534**
  - **Email: cts5@altour.mx**

- Mariana Jasmin Miranda Robles – Call Center Manager
  - Phone: 55 8525 2508
  - Email: mmiranda@altour.mx

Staff is also free to contact Altour's Program Manager with questions, concerns.

English:

- Karen Passiak, Senior Client Success Specialist
  - Phone: 305-476-2787
  - Email: kpassiak@tlcorporate.com

Spanish:

- Juan Luis Purcallas - Key Account Manager
  - Email: jpurcallas@altour.mx
  - Phone: +52 558 525 1357

- Alejandro Sánchez - Operations Manager
  - Email: masanchez@altour.mx
  - Phone: +52 558 525 4188

15. Travel Audits

All travel documents must be submitted to the Finance Office (whether in field or at HO) with all appropriate supporting documentation in a format that can easily demonstrate to the external auditors that the policy is being followed and that the internal control system is functioning.

16. Policy Oversight

This policy will be managed by the President & CEO of Partners and recommendations for updates can be forwarded to the Operations Team.

17. Travel Policy Education

All staff (both HO & Field) and consultants (HO based or local) are eligible for a travel policy education session with the HO Finance Office as needed. There will be periodic refreshers sessions with all staff (HO & Field) on an ongoing basis as necessary.

18. Out of Policy Safeguard

If for any reason a staff member feels that they are out of policy, then it is necessary for the staff member to secure approval from their respective supervisor. The HO Finance Office will determine how to respond to any violation of the policy.

Annex A: Per Diem Examples

[Return]

Examples for calculating per diem
Notes:

- General Services Administration (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The Department of Defense (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The State Department establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

i) Normal example with no exceptions

Traveler A, a staff from the HO office in Washington, DC, leaves for a trip to New York City on Monday morning in April. The flight is scheduled to leave at 9AM. The traveler returns back to home-of-record on Thursday by noon.

The M&IE rate in NYC is $76, and in Washington, DC $79, as per the GSA website. The Partners' approved rate is 70% = $53.20 for NYC, and $55.30 for DC (Section 8.2)

The per diem received will be:
Monday = $53.20* 75% = $39.90
Tuesday = $53.20
Wednesday = $53.20
Thursday = $55.30 * 75% = $41.48

Total per diem = $187.78

ii) Departing from home early; arriving home late

Traveler B, a staff from the HO office in Washington, DC, leaves for a trip to Bogota, Colombia on Monday morning in April. The flight is scheduled to leave at 8:00AM. In order to catch the flight, Traveler B must leave the home-of-record at 5:30 AM in order to be at the airport two hours prior to departure. The traveler returns back to home-of-record on Thursday at 10PM.

The M&IE rate is $105, as per the State Department website.
The M&IE rate in Washington, DC $79, as per the GSA website.
The Partners' approved rate is 70% = $73.50 for Bogota, Colombia, and $55.30 for DC

The per diem received will be:
Monday = $73.50 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler B is leaving the home-of-record before 6AM, as per Section 8.1.2, full per diem is applied)
Tuesday = $73.50
Wednesday = $73.50
Thursday = $55.30 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler B is arriving to the home-of-record after 7PM, as per Section 8.1.2, full per diem is applied)

Total per diem = $275.80

iii) Some meals covered by other sources

Traveler C, a staff from HO in Washington, DC, attends a conference in Panama City, leaving on flight on Monday at 11AM, attending the conference on Tuesday – Thursday, and returning on Friday morning, arriving to home-of-record after 9PM. During the conference, meals are provided for breakfast and lunch.

The Panama City M&IE rate is $99, as per the State Department website.
The M&IE rate in Washington, DC $79, as per the GSA website.
The Partners' approved rate is 70% = $69.30 in Panama and $55.30 for DC
Meal breakdown is as follows, as per Section 8.1.2:
Breakfast @ the $69.30 = $11; Lunch = $17; Dinner = $28; Incidentals = $14 (numbers rounded to nearest dollar)

The per diem received will be:

Monday = $69.30 * 75% = $51.98	(Panama City is the destination city and the rate to utilize on this first travel day)
Tuesday = $28 + $14 = $42	(Dinner plus incidentals)
Wednesday = $28 + $14 = $42	(Dinner plus incidentals)
Thursday = $28 + $14 = $42	(Dinner plus incidentals)

Friday = $55.30 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler C is arriving to the home-of-record after 7PM, as per Section 8.1.2, full per diem is applied; also, Washington, DC rate to be utilized, since on the last day the traveler will return home, and this is their place of rest.)

Total per diem = $233.28

1424 K Street NW Suite 700 Washington DC 20005 202.628.3300 www.partners.net

Annex B: Affidavit in lieu of Receipt

[Return]

I certify the following charges are true and correct and made for the business purpose outlined below.

Purpose/Event:

Date	Description	Amount	Payment Method

Signed,

Traveler's Name   Date

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Annex C: Travel Report Template

[Return]

(Format specific to each project/unit)

Annex D: 2 CFR Part 200: Unallowable Costs

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